

Problem 5. Kavalan Answers

5.1	1. <i><u>His monkey</u> is sleeping / sleeps.</i>
	2. <i>Does the woman burn <u>Taipei</u>?</i>
	3. <i>He buys my digging chicken with <u>our money</u>.</i>
	4. <i><u>We</u> begin to cut the small sour orange in that village.</i>
5.2	5. kitutiku ni [2]
	6. ipiran + na qanay sunisna + ya qasirray wasusu [4]
	7. taquzti + ya tiapzangawta + ta tarrebciaan + ni [4]
	8. titataktati + tu rasung + ya sarriqku [4]
	9. tmaytatiisu + tu rrutungcia + ta rasungan [4]

Q 5.1 Max 12. 3 pts if correct; 2 pts with one mistake; 1 pt if either all noun phrases are correct or the verb phrase is correct, and the correct syntactic argument is focused (even if the translation of the argument is incorrect). Question marking is considered part of the verb phrase.

Q 5.2 Max 18. 1 pt for each noun phrase in the correct order; 2 pts for the verb phrase (including final **ni**), or 1 pt with one mistake.

Q 5.3 Max 30. 6 for describing the syntax; 11 for describing the structure of noun phrases; 13 for describing the structure of verbs.

Problem 5. Kavalan Commentary

UnF = Unfocused, S = Subject, O = Object, V = Verb. Note that instrumental clauses (*with X*) only appear focused in this problem, and locatives only appear unfocused.

1. V + [na] UnF.S + [tu] UnF.O + [ya] Focus + [ta] Locative-[an] + [ni = Question]
2. Art + [Adj-[ay]] + [Noun-[Person]-[cia = that]] NB: Any verb can be used as an adjective.
3. Intransitive verbs focus the only argument. Transitive verbs mark the focus:
 - **-m-** (inserted after the first consonant): subject focus;
 - **-an** (suffix): object focus;
 - **ti-** (prefix): instrumental focus.
4. Person/number markers are attached to the end of the verb (to mark subject) or noun (to mark possession).
 - **-ku** = I, **-su** = you, **-na** = he, **-ta** = we;
 - If the subject is focused, these are preceded by **-i-** and its position is moved after the inceptive marker*.
5. Inceptive marker: **-ti** (*begin to*). This appears after the focus and unfocused person markers, but before the focused person markers.

References and further reading:

- Li, P. J. K., Tsuchida, S. (2006). *Kavalan dictionary*. Institute of Linguistics, Academia Sinica.